

Board 1

West Deals

None Vul

♠ J 8 6 3 2
♥ Q 10 8 4
♦ 9 8 3
♣ A

♠ 9

♥ A 9 3

♦ K 5 2

♣ K J 10 9 6 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A Q 10 5

♥ J 7 6 2

♦ Q J 10 7

♣ 5

♠ K 7 4

♥ K 5

♦ A 6 4

♣ Q 8 7 4 3

West	North	East	South
Pass	1 ♣	Pass	3 ♣
Pass	5 ♣		
All Pass			

5 ♣ by North

Losers: ♠ 1 : ♥ 0 : ♦ 1 : ♣ 1 : Total = 3

Is there any doubt? Although you only have 11 HCP your 6-card suit adds 2 more. And with 13 points you should always open. So you open 1 ♣.

Partner responds 3 ♣.

With the ♣ fit your hand is now revalued to 15 points. But it's still a close thing. You may be able to make 5 ♣ or you may not.

Passing would not be horrible - but when in doubt it is usually better to be bold. You cross your fingers and bid 5 ♣.

North plays 5 ♣. East leads the ♦ Q.

North plays 5 ♣. East leads the ♦ Q.

The two black Aces aren't going away so if you are to make this contract you must do something about your ♦ loser. And the only likely place to put it is on dummy's ♠ K. If East has the ♠ A, you can lead up to the ♠ K and make a winner out of it.

Suppose you win the ♦ Q in dummy and play a ♣. Somebody will win the ♣ A and play another ♦. You win this and lead toward the ♠ K. No good. East jumps up with his ♠ A and sets you with a ♦ winner.

The problem was that when you played a trump you let the timing go to the defense. They could knock out your last ♦ stopper while they still had the ♠ A. Try it this way.

Win the ♦ in your hand and immediately play the ♠ 9. If East doesn't take his ♠ A he'll never get it, so assume he goes up. Now he leads ♦ J but you win, get to dummy with the ♥ K and play the ♠ K, discarding the ♦ loser.

Pulling trumps is very important, but sometimes there is something you must do **BEFORE** you play trumps.

In this hand that something is to establish the ♠ K so you can discard your ♦ loser.

Board 3

North Deals

E-W Vul

♠ Q J 5
 ♥ J 8 7 3
 ♦ Q 7 4
 ♣ K Q 10

♠ K 4 2

♥ 5 2

♦ 9 8 3 2

♣ A 7 6 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A 6 3

♥ K Q 10 9 6 4

♦ A K J

♣ 8

♠ 10 9 8 7

♥ A

♦ 10 6 5

♣ J 9 5 4 2

West	North	East	South
	Pass	1♥	Pass
3♥	Pass	4NT	Pass
5♣	Pass	5♥	
All Pass			

5♥ by East

Losers: ♠ 1 : ♥ 1 : ♦ 0 : ♣ 1 : Total = 3

You have a very good hand. But not good enough to open 2♣, so you open 1♥.

Partner jumps to 3♥.

This is close. Partner has 11 or 12 points and good ♥ support. Your hand revalues to 21 points. You might have a slam. You decide to try for it and bid 4NT. Partner replies 5♣ showing no Aces. So much for the slam. You bid 5♥.

East plays 5♥. South leads the ♠10. You put on dummy's ♠J, North plays the ♠K and you win the ♠A.

East plays 5♥. South leads the ♠T. You put on dummy's ♠J, North plays the ♠K and you win the ♠A.

You cannot avoid losing either of the two Aces. So therefore you must do something about the ♠ loser. And the only thing you can do with it is to discard it on one of dummy's ♣s.

Be careful. If you lead a trump now a defender will take the Ace and play another ♠, exposing your loser while the ♣A is still out. You must set up the ♣ first. So at trick 2 play your ♣ to dummy's ♣Q. A defender may win this and play a ♠, but you win the ♠Q and play the ♣K, discarding your ♠ loser. Now you switch to trumps.

The way you decide whether to start pulling trumps right away is to use your imagination.

Imagine what the defense will do if you lead a round of trumps. Then imagine what they will do if you play a different suit instead.